Weekly Record 6: Marketing and Customer

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Chapters 11–12, Marketing and Customers · Company B: Bayan Sulu · Full record, Fields 1–6 · Develops into Capstone Section 5b, Marketing and customer.

Field 1 · Concept

Key terms from Chapters 11 and 12 [1]:

- Marketing concept: first find out what customers need, then make a product for that need and still make a profit.
- Customer value: what the customer gets for what they pay. This is not only money, but also time and effort.
- Customer satisfaction: the customer feels the product was as good as they expected, or better.
- Relationship marketing: trying to keep the same customers for years instead of selling to them once.
- Environmental scanning: watching what happens outside the company, like competitors, prices and new laws.
- Market segmentation: dividing customers into groups (by region, age, lifestyle or the benefit they want) and then choosing a target market.
- Marketing mix (4Ps): product, price, place and promotion. The book also adds people as a fifth P.
- Distribution channel: the way a product travels from the factory to the shop.

Concept Check: What is the difference between customer value and customer satisfaction?

I understand it like this. Value is about the moment before you buy, when you look at the price and decide if it is worth it. Satisfaction comes after, when you have eaten the chocolate and you either want it again or you don't. Good value can win the first sale, but people only come back if they are satisfied. I think AI can help a little with value, for example by testing prices. Satisfaction is something only real customers can tell you.

Field 2 · Application

For the practice task I compared two ways Bayan Sulu could do its marketing: only with people, or with AI helping. I used the 4Ps and the customer journey from the chapter.

I wanted a real situation, so I used Gulfood. In January 2026 Bayan Sulu went to this exhibition in Dubai. It was the company's first international exhibition, and they had B2B meetings with partners from the UAE [2]. Buyers in the Gulf look for halal food, so my target segment is halal-seeking families in the Gulf. It is a new market for Bayan Sulu, which makes it a good place to think about AI.

4P / step	Only people	With AI	Risk and who checks
Research	Talk to people at the	AI reads online reviews	AI does not know local

4P / step	Only people	With AI	Risk and who checks
	trade show, visit some shops, ask the distributor	and competitor prices in the UAE (Arabic and English)	taste, so a marketer still visits shops
Product	Send the same best-sellers we sell in Kazakhstan	AI looks at reviews to see which flavours and box sizes Gulf families like	Halal and label rules; the quality team approves every label
Price	Check competitor prices by hand	AI tests different prices and suggests a range	Changing prices can feel unfair; the export manager sets the final price
Place	Find one importer from the Gulfood contacts	AI predicts demand for supermarkets and online shops	Bad data means a bad forecast; compare it with real orders every month
Promotion	One agency makes one campaign	AI writes many ad versions in Arabic, English and Kazakh	Bad translations or ads that don't look like Bayan Sulu; a native speaker and the brand manager approve each ad
Customer journey (awareness, purchase, loyalty)	Same message for everybody	A different message for each group, and a loyalty offer after the first purchase	Customer data has to follow Kazakhstan's law; AI cannot decide about a customer alone [3]

Looking at the table, AI is clearly faster and cheaper for research, translation and making lots of ad versions. But people are still better at taste and trust, and they know how Bayan Sulu should sound. The brand is more than 50 years old [2], and I don't think speed is worth risking that. So I think AI should prepare the options and a person should choose. In every row there is someone who signs off at the end.

Field 3 · Verification and AI

What I checked:

- Gulfood facts. I checked the dates (26–30 January), the first Kazakhstan pavilion, the B2B meetings and the quote from the Head of Marketing on the KazFoodProducts press release [2]. Everything matched. One thing I changed: the article only talks about meetings, not signed contracts, so I call the Gulf a possible new market and not a current one.

- Data law in Kazakhstan. I read a law-firm summary from July 2026 [3]. Under the new rules, a decision cannot be made only by automated processing, and people can object to it. That is why the last row of my table says AI cannot decide about a customer alone.
- Ferrero's AI marketing (the 7 million Nutella labels and the customer groups in Google BigQuery). I already checked these in Weekly Record 3, so I took them from my Evidence Folder [4], [5] instead of searching again.
- The key terms, which I compared with the glossary in the OpenStax book [1].

AI use: I used Claude (Anthropic) to help me find the key terms and to make a first version of the table. After that I checked the facts and sources myself and rewrote the text.

Field 4 · Transfer

I think Bayan Sulu should use AI to prepare marketing work, but people should keep the brand voice and make every decision that touches the customer.

Choice	AI idea	My reason for Bayan Sulu
Adopt	AI that scans reviews and competitor prices for research	It is cheap and low risk, and it helps before entering the Gulf
Adapt	Customer groups, like Ferrero does with Google BigQuery [5]	Bayan Sulu has much less online data, so it can start with simple groups from marketplace and distributor sales, with consent
Pilot	AI ad versions in different languages	Try it on one product line and one UAE channel first, with a native speaker checking
Delay	Unique AI-designed labels, like Ferrero's 7 million Nutella jars [4]	Nice idea, but expensive. People in the Gulf need to know the brand first
Reject	Prices that change automatically	Families could feel cheated, and the 2026 law does not allow decisions made only by automated processing [3]

Field 5 · Evidence

This week I added two new sources to the Evidence Folder, [2] and [3]. Sources [4] and [5] are from Weekly Record 3.

[1] L. J. Gitman, C. McDaniel, A. Shah, M. Reece, L. Koffel, B. Talsma, and J. C. Hyatt, *Introduction to Business*, 2nd ed. Houston, TX, USA: OpenStax, 2026, chs. 11–12. [Online]. Available: https://openstax.org/details/books/introduction-business-2e

[2] KazFoodProducts, "Bayan Sulu Confectionery Captivates Gulfood - 2026 and Expands into New Markets," press release, Jan. 30, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://kfp.kz/en/press-center/baian-sulu-konditerlik-fabrikasy-gulfood-2026-kormesin-bagyndyrdy (accessed Oct. 14, 2026).

[3] A. Shyngyssov and B. Kadyrov, "Republic of Kazakhstan Data Protection Law: Amendments in 2026," Morgan Lewis LawFlash, Jul. 14, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://www.morganlewis.com/pubs/2026/07/republic-of-kazakhstan-data-protection-law-amendments-in-2026 (accessed Oct. 14, 2026).

[4] Futurism, "An Algorithm Designed 7 Million One-Of-A-Kind Labels for a Nutella Campaign," Futurism. [Online]. Available: https://futurism.com/an-algorithm-designed-7-million-one-of-a-kind-labels-for-a-nutella-campaign (accessed Sep. 17, 2026).

[5] Google Cloud, "Ferrero Case Study," Google Cloud. [Online]. Available: https://cloud.google.com/customers/ferrero (accessed Sep. 17, 2026).

Field 6 · Capstone link

This record will become Capstone Section 5b, Marketing and customer. The comparison table will be the main exhibit, because it shows where AI saves time and where a person has to approve.

In the Capstone I want to turn the Pilot row into a real test with costs: one product line, one channel in the Gulf, and ads that a native speaker approves. I would measure sales per store and how many customers buy again. It also connects to Section 6 (Week 7), because the customer data from marketing needs its own rules.